

OCBC Bank

Steady 4Q25 at GE; stay Neutral on OCBC

Neutral

OCBC.SI, OCBC.SP

Price (23 Feb 26): S\$21.69

Price Target (Dec-26): S\$20.50

OCBC's insurance subsidiary GE reported 4Q25 net income of S\$241mn, up 79% y/y but down 35% q/q from an unusually strong 3Q25 on shareholders' fund performance. GE's contribution to OCBC profits normalized to 14% from 20% in 3Q, with 4Q in line with longer-term trends. Core trends were a touch better with TWNS up 5% y/y led by Singapore, with NBEV up a stronger 25% y/y, likely on product mix. Overall, these are steady results at GE.

In addition to GEH, NISP and Bank of Ningbo (4Q pre-announcement in-line, [link](#)), key stock price drivers from OCBC results tomorrow will be NIM, NNMg and AQ for 4Q25, as well as 2026 and next 3Y guidance for RoE and capital returns. We continue to maintain N on the stock, with a preference for DBS and SGX in the sector.

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Table 1: GE: 3Q25 Earnings Snapshot

S\$mn	4Q25	3Q25	2Q25	1Q25	4Q24	QoQ	YoY
Total Weighted New Sales	453.7	373.1	363.5	345.1	432.7	22%	5%
New Business Embedded Value	241.0	182.2	167.7	148.8	105.7	32%	128%
Profit from Insurance Business	172.2	228.8	168.4	246.8	92.6	-25%	86%
Profit from Shareholders' Fund	69.2	143.2	79.8	98.7	42.2	-52%	64%
Profit Attributable to Shareholders	241.4	372.0	248.2	345.5	134.8	-35%	79%

Source: Company data.

Table 2: GE: New Business Embedded Value (NBEV) by market

S\$ millions	4Q25	3Q25	2Q25	1Q25	4Q24	QoQ	YoY
Singapore	112	102	67	71	75	10%	49%
Malaysia	127	77	99	75	115	64%	10%
Emerging Markets	3	3	2	2	3	-7%	-19%
Total	241	182	168	149	193	32%	25%

Source: Company data.

See page 5 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

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Table 3: GE: Total Weighted New Sales (TWNS) by market

<i>S\$ millions</i>	4Q25	3Q25	2Q25	1Q25	4Q24	QoQ	YoY
SINGAPORE							
Agency	151	117	92	102	135	29%	12%
Banca	101	124	119	94	84	-19%	21%
Others	7	11	19	20	10	-37%	-31%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	259	252	230	216	229	3%	13%
MALAYSIA							
Agency	171	102	113	90	179	68%	-4%
Banca	9	6	5	6	9	52%	-9%
Others	6	6	9	26	6	14%	8%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	186	113	127	122	194	64%	-4%
OTHER ASIA							
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	9	8	7	8	10	14%	-11%
TOTAL							
Total Weighted New Sales	454	373	364	345	433	22%	5%

Source: Company data.

Table 4: OCBC: 4Q25 Earnings Preview

P&L (\$\$mn)	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25E	YoY	QoQ
Interest Income	5,617	5,410	4,994	4,824	4,732	-16%	-2%
Interest Expense	(3,162)	(3,065)	(2,711)	(2,598)	(2,510)	-21%	-3%
Net Interest Income	2,455	2,345	2,283	2,226	2,222	-10%	0%
Non-Interest Income	961	1,310	1,264	1,570	1,276	33%	-19%
Net Fee Income	517	546	580	683	604	17%	-12%
Trading Income	343	458	458	576	441	29%	-23%
Other Operating Income	101	306	226	311	230	128%	-26%
Total Revenues	3,416	3,655	3,547	3,796	3,497	2%	-8%
Costs	(1,560)	(1,415)	(1,389)	(1,519)	(1,577)	1%	4%
PPOP	1,856	2,240	2,158	2,277	1,920	3%	-16%
Loan Loss Provisions	(297)	(212)	(87)	(139)	(193)	-35%	38%
Pre-Tax	1,888	2,297	2,301	2,412	2,014	7%	-16%
Tax	(235)	(390)	(439)	(378)	(327)	39%	-14%
Profit before MI	1,653	1,907	1,862	2,034	1,687	2%	-17%
MI and EO	34	(24)	(46)	(56)	(51)	-250%	-8%
Core Attributable Profit	1,687	1,883	1,816	1,978	1,636	-3%	-17%
Reported Net Profits	1,687	1,883	1,816	1,978	1,636	-3%	-17%
DPS (\$\$)	0.57	-	0.41	-	0.60	5%	n.a
Common Equity	57,166	59,416	58,299	57,813	59,624	4%	3%
Gross Loans	319,166	322,175	324,606	327,060	331,845	4%	1%
Net Loans	315,096	317,885	320,413	322,729	327,496	4%	1%
Deposits	390,687	402,732	406,943	410,596	419,478	7%	2%
NPLs	2,827	2,898	2,983	2,944	3,050	8%	4%
LLR	4,070	4,290	4,193	4,331	4,349	7%	0%
Change in bps							
NIM	2.15%	2.04%	1.92%	1.84%	1.82%	(33)	(2)
CIR	45.7%	38.7%	39.2%	40.0%	45.1%	(58)	507
LDR	81%	79%	79%	79%	78%	(258)	(53)
CASA Ratio	48.8%	48.9%	49.8%	50.3%	50.4%	161	13
Credit Costs (bps)	38	26	11	17	23	(15)	6
NPL Ratio	0.89%	0.90%	0.92%	0.90%	0.92%	3	2
Coverage Ratio	144%	148%	141%	147%	143%	(138)	(457)
Tier 1	17.8%	18.3%	17.8%	17.6%	17.3%	(55)	(31)
CAR	19.7%	20.2%	19.6%	19.4%	19.0%	(70)	(41)

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

OCBC Bank *(Neutral; Price Target: S\$20.50)*

Investment Thesis

We are Neutral on OCBC.

- The bank has built a multi-brand financial conglomerate in Asia, with Wing Hang, BoS, GEH and Bank of Ningbo being the main acquisitions/stake increases in the last 20 years, with Lion Global being a product of the merger between OCBC/GEH AMs. The group is generating 1.13% RoA with ~11x leverage in 2025.
- The track-record suggests OCBC is more likely to use excess capital to buy rather than increase payout significantly. While management is committed to the current S\$2.5bn capital return plan, visibility for further increases in payout is low in 1H26, with the bank guiding for limited shifts until end 2026.
- We assume that absolute DPS will stay steady in 2025-27, despite EPS movements. A potential risk is if the bank allows DPS to reduce in line with EPS. We further forecast S\$500-600mn of buyback every year, which adds about 0.7% to total returns in 2026/27. However, buybacks could be lower given the bank's reluctance to buyback at significantly above book value.
- The bank is benefitting from significant inflows of funds into Singapore, and in SGD. The preference for NII growth suggests that the risks to NIM may be higher as rates reset lower.
- The bank's track record on inorganic growth could lead to near-term risks if growth in Greater China is via inorganic means and transactions are not immediately accretive.
- Following the rally in the last 12M, risk-reward has moved closer to fair at current valuations.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of S\$20.5 is based on a fair P/B of 1.40x, assuming a normalized RoE of 12.2%, a risk-free rate of 4.1%, a cost of capital of 9.9% and a growth rate of 4.3%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include a significant improvement in DPS, a meaningfully value-accretive deal, better than-expected growth at GE, and better-than-expected WM fees. Bank of Ningbo (20%-owned by OCBC) has competitive advantages in local SMEs and high-net-worth retail clients, which could drive faster growth at the group.

Downside risks include weaker-than-expected NIM, market share losses in wealth management, lack of increases in capital return, and M&A, if transactions are not immediately accretive.

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DBS Group Holdings(DBSM.SI/S\$58.15/OW), Singapore Exchange(SGXL.SI/S\$17.97/OW)

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
09-Mar-23	OW	12.55	13.5
30-Mar-23	UW	12.53	11.5
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18
08-Aug-25	N	17.09	17.5
10-Sep-25	N	16.76	17
28-Nov-25	OW	18.27	20
09-Jan-26	N	20.17	20.5

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Feb 24, 2000. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

DBS Group Holdings (DBSM.SI, DBS SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
09-Mar-23	N	30.64	31
30-Mar-23	UW	30.54	27
05-Oct-23	UW	30.20	28
09-Dec-23	UW	28.73	27.5
13-Mar-24	N	30.46	30
03-Jul-24	OW	37.10	41
06-Oct-24	OW	38.04	42
10-Nov-24	OW	42.40	50
11-Feb-25	OW	45.38	51
23-Mar-25	OW	45.31	49
21-May-25	N	44.38	47
13-Jul-25	N	45.99	48
08-Aug-25	N	49.75	50.5
10-Sep-25	OW	50.88	56
28-Nov-25	OW	54.00	70

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Singapore Exchange (SGXL.SI, SGX SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
29-Nov-23	N	9.39	10
20-May-24	OW	9.24	10.5
22-Aug-24	N	10.60	10.5
12-Sep-24	UW	11.76	10.5
06-Oct-24	UW	11.68	11
28-Jan-25	UW	12.23	11.1
13-Feb-25	UW	13.66	11
09-Apr-25	N	12.02	11
27-Apr-25	UW	14.36	12.8
16-Jul-25	UW	15.67	14
10-Sep-25	N	16.35	16
28-Nov-25	OW	16.60	18.5
03-Feb-26	OW	17.56	19

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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